

lets you half press the button to lock focus. Some will do it for you when you hit the shutter button and then the camera automatically focuses and takes a picture. The latter can be a bit unreliable and if possible you should always take multiple shots just to be sure or try and lock focus before you take the photo.

Most phones will let you tap on the screen to lock focus and exposure to that point. Instead of messing around with the exposure settings, you could always use this to tap at various points in the frame to select the appropriate exposure level for the entire frame. Sometimes, you will have one bright spot in the frame, in which case it is preferable to focus on that and adjust the exposure to it so that it doesn't get blown to a bright white spot in the final image.

You can trick the focus into focusing at a particular and stay there. Most phones don't have manual focus, which means you can't just leave the focus at one particular point. What you can do instead is find an object with the right amount of distance and light value and lock focus (and exposure) on it. Then, keep the shutter button held and then release it when the subject you intend to shoot comes into the frame. This is useful for capturing moving objects that don't stay in the frame long enough to capture using auto focus.

Flash

There is only one rule when it comes to the flash on a camera and that is to avoid using it as much as possible when you are going for artistic photography. Flash produces a harsh white light that upsets the mood of the situation and makes the subject appear far too bright. A photo taken without flash has the natural lighting and looks far more pleasing to the eye. The only time you should use flash when it is absolutely essential, that is when it would otherwise be difficult or impossible to see the subject but otherwise you should avoid using the flash altogether.

Digital Zoom

Unlike proper cameras and maybe a handful of phones, most smartphones don't have optical zoom on them. Optical zoom is the only real zoom, where you don't compromise the image quality while zooming in. Digital zoom is not real zoom. The camera software essentially crops the image and then blows it up to fit the original resolution. This results in blurry, pixellated images and why you should always avoid using digital zoom. A better solution would be to take the photo without using any digital zoom and